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Top Skills

Communication
Engineering Management
Technical Leadership

Languages

English

Eric Hickey

Director - Software Development at BuildOn Technologies
Greater Houston

Summary

As the Director of Software Development at BuildOn Technologies, I lead the strategic direction and innovation of two key development teams. With 25 years of professional experience and a rock-solid foundation in .Net development, I offer a unique blend of leadership and technical expertise.

I foster a culture of collaboration, continuous learning, and quality across the VEO Design Studio Team and the VEO Indago Team, ensuring alignment with company objectives and client satisfaction. I also serve as an interim Scrum Master, championing agile methodologies and overseeing efficient project delivery. Some of my leadership initiatives include initiating a full-stack, professional development training channel, and facilitating the introduction of a robust Quality Assurance program

I have successfully transitioned from Loan Origination to Oil & Gas and then to Home Building, demonstrating my adaptability and versatility. Each move has expanded my perspective, reinforcing the importance of agility in our rapidly changing field.

My leadership is anchored in clear communication, strategic planning, and proactive problem-solving. I strike a balance between high-level strategies and meticulous attention to detail, and I am enthusiastic about contributing my skills, knowledge, and passion to any organization I'm a part of.

Experience

BuildOn Technologies

10 years 7 months

Director - Software Development

February 2020 - Present (6 years 4 months)

Houston, Texas, United States

At BuildOn Technologies, I serve as a driving force behind strategic direction and innovation. My leadership focuses on fostering a culture of continuous growth, enhancing product quality, and streamlining processes across key development teams.

Key Responsibilities:

- Shaping company-wide strategic decisions as an integral member of the Senior Leadership Team.
- Direct management of two distinct development teams, ensuring alignment with company objectives.
- Interim Scrum Master for both teams, championing agile methodologies and overseeing efficient project delivery.

Leadership Initiatives:

- Initiated a full-stack professional development training channel, enhancing continuous learning and skills for the development teams.
- Facilitated the introduction of a robust Quality Assurance program, improving product quality and minimizing post-release defects.
- Initiated and led several book clubs, promoting continuous learning, team bonding, and the exchange of diverse perspectives.

Accomplishments:

- Overseeing multiple development teams, focusing on motivation, productivity, and quality.
- Streamlining project planning and resource allocation, meeting strategic goals.
- Co-architected a new product catalog management system using Domain Driven Design to enhance end-user capabilities to manage very large product sets.
- Refining software development processes, boosting efficiency and output quality.
- Collaborating with stakeholders, managing expectations, and delivering projects on time.
- Identifying and mitigating risks to ensure timely project completion.
- Advocating for talent development and nurturing a culture of continuous learning and growth.

Senior Technical Lead - VEO Design Studio

October 2019 - February 2020 (5 months)

Houston, Texas, United States

Led the development of an application for homebuyers to view and select available options for their new home, which streamlines the design center experience, saving time and money for home builders. The application includes real-time option availability, budget projections and selection visualization.

Accomplishments:

- Led the effort to convert the application from .NET Framework to .NET Core.
- Implemented Entity Framework and established repository and specification patterns.
- Created a provider model that abstracted the visualization vendor and permitted new vendors to be implemented with minimal work.

Senior Technical Lead - VEO Indago

November 2015 - October 2019 (4 years)

Houston, Texas Area

Led the design and development of an application that manages residential countertop manufacturing, from inventory selection to shipping. The application allowed the client to eliminate paper processing, optimize machine and material usage to increase throughput, and integrated with an external system for order generation and data reporting.

Accomplishments:

- Developed a Single Page Application using Typescript and Aurelia.
- Backend created in C# using a RESTful Web API in ASP.Net MVC, with the model and business logic implemented using Domain Driven Design principles along with Sql Server accessed by Entity Framework.
- Implemented and managed a continuous integration and delivery process using Azure DevOps. Included automated test execution and environment specific deployments and automated database updates.
- Served as Scrum Master, leading daily standup, retrospectives and reviews. Managed sprint goals and sprint tracking. Facilitated backlog and story grooming with the Product Owner.

ABB

Technical Lead

January 2013 - September 2015 (2 years 9 months)

Houston, Texas, United States

Technical lead for a greenfield .NET/C# project in the oil and gas industry, creating a Process Safety Management product. In charge of technical design,

application structure and software development lifecycle. Additionally, provided team guidance for best practices, design, and development.

Accomplishments:

- Designed and developed the primary application using Domain Driven Design in .NET and C#, with an ASP.Net MVC front-end, including JavaScript for improved client experience and asynchronous data retrieval. Sql Server and Entity Framework back-end.
- Designed and implemented a JSON-Based, RESTful Web API for external integrations.
- Created a continuous integration environment using Team Build, including automated test execution, automated deployments, style enforcement and static code analysis.
- Provide specification and design documentation for user stories.
- Fully involved with the software development lifecycle, creating a code review process, coding standards, development best practices, user story management and source control structure.

Black Knight

10 years 9 months

Senior Software Architect

November 2008 - January 2013 (4 years 3 months)

Houston, Texas, United States

Subject matter expert in the legacy system, participated as a member of a small team tasked with re-architecting the enterprise system and enhancing / maintaining the existing system. Served as a key hands-on contributor in the software product development life-cycle, performing analysis, driving software architecture and design, development, and integration.

Accomplishments:

- Primary architect on the redesign of the core engine, which processes millions of messages per day for the largest banks in the country. Included highly configurable data transformations, data storage, and complex workflows. Used C#, MSMQ, XSLT, XML, MS SQL Server and WCF.
- Implemented functionality to support PCI compliance, including private data and encryption.
- Provided technical documentation, both for development and key stakeholders.

- Led design sessions in the early stages of the project using principles of Domain Driven Design to create a rich domain model that modeled business interaction.
- Continued to develop on legacy system using ASP.NET, C# and JavaScript to enhance client experience.

Web Development Manager

August 2006 - November 2008 (2 years 4 months)

Houston, Texas, United States

Managed web development team, delegating workload to team and providing performance reviews, guidance and mentoring.

Accomplishments:

- Led a team of 6 to 10 web developers.
- Played a key role bringing on board one of the nation's largest lending institutions as a client on an accelerated timeline. Required changes to the core system and large changes to the web application to support the client's complex workflow.
- On Primary Production Support Team, helped ensure the viability of the system, and worked as a first responder to restore functionality in the event of a server outage or software defect.
- On Disaster Recovery Team, helped establish processes and procedures that would ensure continued operational ability in the event of production facility failure and served as 24-hour first responder to bring systems up in event of a fail-over.

Senior Web Developer - Team Lead

October 2004 - August 2006 (1 year 11 months)

Houston, Texas

In addition to responsibilities as web developer, served as technical resource to Black Knight by assisting with best practices for functionality and design. Provided backup for workflow overload of web development team.

Accomplishments:

- Participated in design meetings to establish viable solutions to requirements. Guided upper management in design to maintain balance between ease of maintenance and successful implementation of client requirements.
- Worked in ASP.NET and C# environment.
- Using a third party PDF tool, added ability for PDF document upload and data harvesting. This data was sent through a configurable rules engine that would determine if data had errors and display results to the user.

Web Developer

May 2002 - October 2004 (2 years 6 months)

Houston, Texas

Developed and implemented new functionality. 24 hour on-call primary production support for the web site and HTTP Posting Applications. Managed and improved .Net applications using ASP (VBScript), ASP.NET (C#) and IIS.

Secure Digital Assets

Web Developer

February 2001 - March 2002 (1 year 2 months)

Houston, Texas, United States

Served a key role in developing, implementing and maintaining a web-based digital asset management system. Provided a rich feature set using VBScript, JavaScript, and cross-platform HTML in an IIS and ASP environment.

Frontera.com

Web Developer

May 1999 - February 2001 (1 year 10 months)

Houston, Texas, United States

Performed development and maintenance of the Frontera.com website using ASP and VBScript. Created user-friendly environments, combining usability, simple navigation and complex functionality.
